EVOLUTION OF MACHINE TRANSLATION & TRANSLATIONESE (1990s-2025)

CORPUS-BASED ERA (1990s-2000s)

1993: Baker-Translation Universals

Translation Universals

- Simplification
- Normalization
- Explicitation

Manual Analysis

- Corpus comparison
- Linguistic features

SMT ERA (2003-2015)

2003: Koehn et al. – Phrase-based SMT

Awkward Literalism

- Source interference
- Word-for-word idioms
- Unnatural word order

Feature-Based

- SVM
- N-grams
- POS tags

NMT ERA (2015-2020)

2015: Bahdanau – Attention Mechanism

2017: Vaswani – Transformer

Deceptive Fluency

- Lexical diversity loss
- Over-simplification
- Post-editese

Neural Approaches

- BERT
- LSTM
- Feature learning

LLM ERA (2020-2025)

2020+: GPT – LLM Translation

Subtle Over-Adherence

- Excessive literalism
- Over-normalization
- Stylistic flattening

LLM-Based

- Prompting
- Few-shot
- Zero-shot detection

⚠ **Risk:** Model Collapse, Data Contamination

Milestone | Translationese | Detection

2015 2020 2025